

**5000!**

Yes, that is the number of exoplanets that have so far been discovered by NASA. <https://digit.in/apr22-05>

**Too bright!**

The visible background glow of the universe recorded by New Horizons spacecraft is brighter than expected. <https://digit.in/apr22-06>



Super DNA test!

50 genetic diseases can now be diagnosed thanks to a single new and accurate test

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ome neurological and neuromuscular genetic diseases are notoriously hard to diagnose. These

diseases are part of this class of 50-plus diseases that are caused by unusually long repetitive DNA sequences in a person's genes. For that reason, these diseases are

known as short tandem repeat (STR) expansion disorders. These diseases can sometimes be so difficult to diagnose that, it may end up taking years to even identify due to the complexity of the testing and diagnosing process.

A new DNA test developed by a team of international researchers can now diagnose these diseases more quickly and accurately than ever before. Before we explore how this new and innovative testing method came about, let's figure out what made testing for these diseases so difficult in the first place. And for that, we need to know exactly what DNA is.

WHAT IS DNA?

The basic and simple answer that we all may have heard at some point

in our lives is that DNA is the recipe of life. A blueprint that makes you, you and grass, grass. It is, of course, present in every living organism from single-celled creatures, viruses to more complex lifeforms like you. A slightly more detailed explanation would be that DNA is essentially a molecule. A bunch of atoms that have come together in the shape of a double helix. It is a database that holds all the information about you. It consists of all the hereditary information that has been passed down from your ancestors, it has all the information about diseases that you might be susceptible to (even if that disease may never manifest) and funnily enough, it has also holds the information to combat pretty much any disease the world may throw at